A-A-20108
August 3, 1984

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CEREAL, WHEAT, FARINA AND WHOLE WHEAT MEAL

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description (CID) in preference to Type I, Class B, Style 2; Type III, Style 2; and Type IV, Class A, Style 2 of Federal Specification N-C-201.

Salient characteristics.

Type I - Farina
Class B - Enriched
Style 2 - Quick-cooking

Type III - Enriched farina with malt, low-sodium content
Style 2 - Quick-cooking

Type IV - Whole wheat cereal with malt
Class A - Whole wheat meal
Style 2 - Quick-cooking

The wheat cereal shall be prepared from clean, sound, and scoured wheat, other than mixed wheat, durum wheat or red durum wheat as defined in the United States Standards for Wheat. The cereal shall be "quick-cooking" so that it shall be ready for table use by boiling in water in an open vessel for not more than five minutes. It shall have a characteristic color and a normal consistency, a normal wheat flavor and odor, and shall be free from rancid, bitter, musty, raw, starchy, sour or other undesirable flavors and odors. It shall not be packed more than 60 days prior to shipment.

TYPE I - Type I cereal (farina) shall be produced by grinding and bolting wheat, with the bran and germ substantially removed, so as to pass through a U.S. Standard No. 20 sieve but not more than 3 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 100 sieve. The product shall comply with the Federal Standard of Identity for Enriched Farina in all respects, except maximum moisture level shall be limited to 14.0 percent. When specified in the contract or solicitation, the product shall contain no added salt.

TYPE III - Type III cereal shall be flavored with malt and meet all other requirements given above for Type I. The sodium content for Type III shall not exceed 7 milligrams per 3.5 ounces of the product.

TYPE IV - Type IV cereal (whole wheat) shall be prepared from wheat without material removal of the bran or germ. The product shall contain added malt. The proportions of the natural constituents of the wheat, other than moisture, shall remain essentially unaltered. The product shall be prepared by grinding

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wheat into granules of such fineness that all will pass through a U.S Standard No. 10 sieve, but not more than 25 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 35 sieve, and not more than 3.0 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 100 sieve. When specified in the contract or solicitation, the product shall contain no added salt.

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product in the commercial marketplace. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Quality assurance.

When required in the contract or purchase order, the quality assurance of the wheat cereal shall be determined by the Federal Grain Inspection Service of the U.S. Department of Agriculture. The product shall be examined and/or tested in accordance with the salient characteristics and analytical requirements in this CID and, when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of the solicitation.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The product shall be preserved, packaged, packed, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the contract or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

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For Department of Defense procurement.

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer:

A. Commercial packaging. Twenty-five to 28 ounces of product shall be packaged in accordance with good commercial practice.

B. Commercial packing. Twenty-four packages as specified shall be packed in containers complying with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable, except metal fasteners shall not be used in the final closure of fiberboard boxes.

C. Commercial unit loads. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with Type III, Class G of MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

D. Export packaging. Twenty-eight ounces of product shall be packaged in accordance with good commercial practice. Alternatively, commercial packs of product can be used as intermediate packages. Twenty-four packages shall then be packaged in an intermediate fiberboard box conforming to Style RSC, Type CF, Class Domestic, Grade 125 of PPP-B-636. Each intermediate box shall be closed in accordance with Method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

E. Export packing. Twenty-four packages of product, intermediate packaged as specified, shall be overpacked in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, and closed in accordance with Style RSC, Grade V3c, V3s or V4s of PPP-B-636. Prior to overpacking, the intermediate box shall be enclosed in a waterproof case liner, fabricated and sealed in accordance with MIL-L-10547 for subsistence items. Exposed metal fasteners on the inside of the shipping container shall be covered with pressure-sensitive tape or paperboard pads to protect the case liner from mechanical damage. Reinforcement shall be restricted to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

F. Export unit loads. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with Type I, Class A of MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

G. Labeling of packages (commercial and export). Labeling of packages shall be in accordance with good commercial practice and shall comply with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

H. Marking of shipping containers (commercial and export). Commercial markings for shipping containers are acceptable, provided the following information is included:

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National Stock Number
Item Description
Quantity, Unit of Issue
Date of Pack (month/year)
Contract Number
Name, Address, and Zip Code of Contractor
Inspection/Test Date

I. Marking of unit loads (commercial and export). Commercial and export unit loads shall be marked on two adjacent sides with the following information:

National Stock Number
Item Description
Number of Containers per Load, Quantity per Container, Unit of Issue
Commercial or Export Unit Load (as applicable)
Date of Pack (month/year)
Inspection/Test Date
Contract Number or Purchase Order Number
Name, Address, and Zip Code of Contractor
Gross Weight (including pallet weight)
Cube

When the markings on one or more individual shipping containers are exposed on two adjacent sides of the unit load, a minimum 3- by 5-inch label shall be applied on the same two adjacent sides of the load. The label shall be marked (letter size not less than 1/2 inch) with the following information:

Number of Containers per Load
Commercial or Export Unit Load (as applicable)
Gross Weight (including pallet weight)
Cube

Notes.

Purchasers should specify:

- Special protein, vitamin, or mineral fortification.
- Labeling requirements, if different from normal commercial practice.
- No added salt for Type I and Type IV, when required.

Sources of documents:

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

National Motor Freight Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
1616 P Street, NW
Washington, DC 20036

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Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This three-volume set may be purchased from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

Civil agencies may obtain copies of this Commercial Item Description from:

General Services Administration
Specification Unit (WFSIS)
Room 6039
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit request for copies to:

Naval Publications and Forms Center
5801 Tabor Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19120

Comments and suggestions.

Comments and suggestions regarding this Commercial Item Description may be submitted to the U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center, ATTN: STRNC-ES, Natick, MA 01760.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - MRD
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

Project No. 8920-0444

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